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TAB 14



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson, Dr. McKenna, Dr. Rivas - LAUSD Art Appreciation and Celebration Week (Res 020-23/24)
(For Action March 12, 2024)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has expanded opportunities for students to showcase their artistic talents through dance, music, theater, media, and the visual arts through the Arts Education Branch;

Whereas, In September 2013, The District passed, “Arts at the Core: Implementing the Arts Education and Creative Network Plan,” which called for increased funding, high-quality professional development, policy guidelines, and others in the educational arts field;

Whereas, The District acknowledges the importance of creativity and individuality in the students, realizing art is part of their lives, cultures, identities, etc;

Whereas, The District identifies 33 magnet schools that have a dedication to the performing or visual arts;

Whereas, The District recognizes 40 Arts Community Partnerships throughout the Los Angeles Region, connecting students from marginalized communities to dance, theater, music, and paint instruction, among others;

Whereas, The District has designated Art Weeks for students to showcase their artistic talents during the months of April and May;

Whereas, Since 1976, The State of California has had a dedicated arts council that has distributed millions of dollars, to local arts organizations, including schools, to ensure students harness the power of their creativity;

Whereas, The California Arts Council recently allocated more than \$32 million, with Los Angeles receiving \$8,576,779 for organizations, some of whom are partners with the District, such as 24th Street Theatre, Enrichment Works, and Versa-Style Dance Co.;

Whereas, In 2022, voters of The State of California overwhelmingly passed Proposition 28, resulting in ongoing 1% of K-12 funding from Prop 98 to be allocated to arts education programs, most recently allocating over \$900 million for arts education in the state;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Region is home to many different media companies, world-famous actors, artists, and writers, and is seen as a major media hub around the world;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Economic Development Corporation has identified that a combination of the film, television, music, the visual and performing arts, generates over \$173,100,000,000 in economic impact while generating hundreds of thousands of jobs;

Whereas, Research shows that children exposed to the arts are more likely to contribute to civic engagement and social tolerance when they reach adulthood;

Whereas, Arts Education has been shown to have a positive impact on students with increased attendance, better communication skills, an increase in self-confidence, and a better interest in their overall education; and

Whereas, The District's Strategic Plan sets a standard to provide students with high-quality instruction, Pilar 1A, enriching experiences, 1B, and eliminating opportunity gaps, 1C; now, therefore be it

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will designate March 18 through March 22 as District Art Appreciation and Celebration Week;

Resolved further, That the District Art Week will expand from the visual and performing arts to also include photography, short stories, poetry, and verbal storytelling;

Resolved further, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District will recommend the superintendent or a designee to seek appropriate spaces around the district or through external partners to showcase our students' artistic talents;

Resolved further, That the District shall extend invitations for all District schools, at all grade levels, to participate in this showcase, either as performers or spectators, it being at the discretion of school leadership; and, be it finally

Resolved, That Board of The Los Angeles Unified School District will recommend that the District seek ways of incorporating the arts into social-emotional learning strategies as a means to provide students with diverse outlets of support in addition to current strategies.